

3 Cystic fibrosis results from mutations in the CFTR gene.

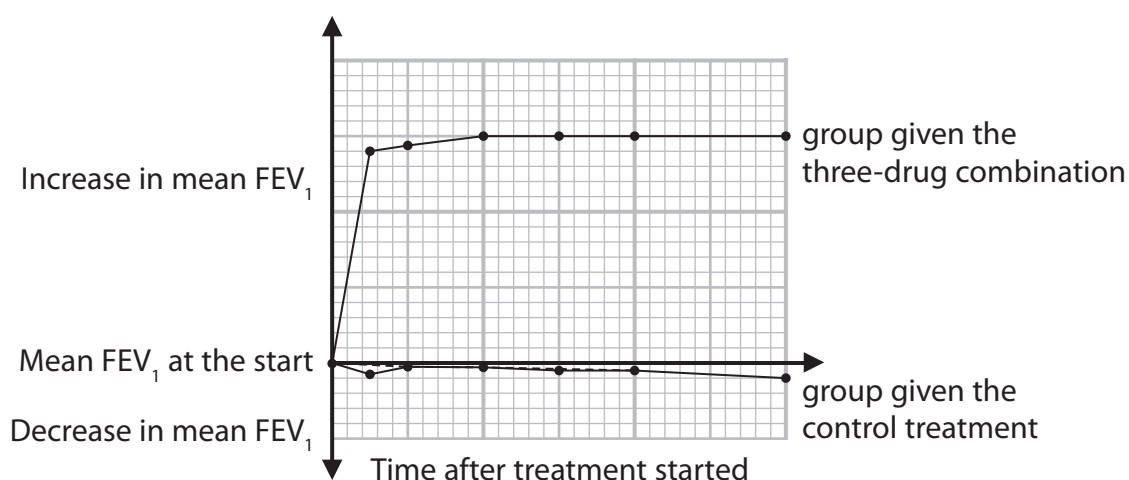
Mutations may occur at a number of positions within the gene, resulting in a range of clinical symptoms and severity of cystic fibrosis.

The effect of combining three different drugs to treat people with cystic fibrosis was investigated.

People with cystic fibrosis were divided into two groups. One group was given the three-drug combination and the other group was given a control treatment.

The volume of air each person could forcefully blow out in one second (FEV_1) was measured.

The graph shows the results of this investigation.



(a) Explain why the change in mean FEV_1 was used in this investigation.

(3)



(Total for Question 3 = 7 marks)